

responsible for sewer issues in the future, that can be a \$7,000-plus problem. During the inspection process, you will probably have to pay extra for a sewer inspection in order to gauge how your home's pipes are working.

While we recommend getting a sewer inspection, especially on an older home, the typical inspection could also reveal an absolute deal breaker before you even think about the sewer. Because sewer scopes cost an extra hundred dollars or so, you can wait to have it done until you are sure the regular inspection doesn't reveal anything that makes you walk away.

Radon, mold, asbestos, lead paint, meth, and even detailed fireplace, swimming pool, and pest inspections also vary on a case-by-case basis. Talk to your agent and inspector about whether you should go forward with any of these—and again, you can always wait until *after* the initial inspection is complete and clear of any red flags. Just make sure to complete all your inspections by the deadline in your contract.

THE HOME INSPECTION REPORT

A day or two after your inspection, the inspector will send you a copy of your report.

Don't freak out. It's *huge*. We're talking 50 to 150 pages long. That's basically the same length as *The Great Gatsby*, but instead of flappers and emotional angst, you get to read about light switches and slow-draining sinks. As thrilling as that sounds, you should sit down, read the report, and take notes as you go. Share it with your agent if the inspector did not.

Nothing in the report should come as a shock, since you walked through everything with your inspector on-site. There will be endless small items that “need” to be fixed—meaning the inspector is required to call them out, but they won't actually make or break your transaction. We've never seen an inspection report where there wasn't at least one missing GFCI outlet near a water source (which is technically a safety hazard, but pretty common in a typical home). Smaller things like a leaky faucet, broken outlet, or faulty light switch are easy DIY fixes, or at least easy to hire out to a handyman.